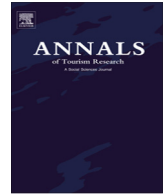




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Creating memorable experiences in a reuse heritage site



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ABSTRACT

This study identified hypothetical relationships amongst motivation, nostalgia, and memorable tourism experiences in a restaurant reconstructed from an old railway station. We administered a face-to-face questionnaire survey and collected 615 valid questionnaires at the South Tainan Railway Station in Taiwan. The results showed significantly positive relationships between culinary attraction and cultural inheritance and nostalgia, as well as a correlation between nostalgia and memorable tourism experiences. Structural equation modelling analysis verified that nostalgia mediated the effect of personal emotion on memorable tourism experiences. This paper provides suggestions for enhancing memorable experiences and guidance regarding reused buildings at heritage sites.

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Introduction

In the current ‘experience economy’ era, business providers stage experiences to create memorable events for customers (Pine & Gilmore, 1998). Stage experiences are not a new tourism phenomenon. The category of authentic experience has been discussed since Boorstin (1964) first criticised mass tourism attractions as pseudoevents, and MacCannell (1973) described them as staged authenticity. Pine and Gilmore (1998) indicated that enterprises must provide original, sincere, and authentic services or products to customers. Previous eras have passed; however, customers can have authentic experiences of events from these eras.

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Reusing and restoring existing heritage sites for continued use have become a creative challenge in the architecture discipline (Powell, 1999; Schittich, 2003). This strategy for preserving historic sites has become a relevant topic in recent years (Bhati, Pryce, & Chaiechi, 2014; Bullen & Love, 2011; Ferretti, Bottero, & Mondini, 2014; Yung & Chan, 2012). Tainan was the political and military centre of Taiwan from 1624 to 1885. It was a gateway to Taiwan in the Dutch colonial period and flourished through the Zheng regime and Qing Dynasty (Tourism Bureau of Tainan City Government, 2014). Numerous old buildings have been reconstructed as restaurants or exhibition spaces in Tainan. Pleasant memories of the past are combined with a sense of loss associated with the realisation that the past cannot be recreated. The combination of art, old amenities, and service products as well as memorable experiences and old stories of reconstructed buildings elicit customer nostalgia (Pine & Gilmore, 1998).

Nostalgia comprises not only emotions but also cognitive responses (Holak & Havlena, 1998). Sedikides, Wildschut, and Baden (2004) stated that nostalgia is a disproportionately positive emotion with bittersweet elements and a yearning for aspects of the past, including events, people, and sights. Some researchers have indicated a positive relationship between motivation and nostalgia (Poria, Bulter, & Airey, 2003; Timothy, 1997). Tourist motivation can be a positive effector for eliciting nostalgia at historic attractions (Poria et al., 2003). An old photograph, a book, or a song can evoke memories of a previous period, as reflected in the consumer market, in which numerous dining and exhibition spaces have been reconstructed from old buildings in the past decade. Such spaces create a nostalgic atmosphere and evoke precious memories for tourists (Tu, 2012).

Pine and Gilmore (1998) argued that experiences are memorable. They regarded experiences as economic goods that can provide unforgettable memories through supporting services and scenarios provided in surroundings during the consumption process. The more senses that an experience involves, the more effective and memorable it is (Pine & Gilmore, 1998; Winter, 2004). 'Peak experiences' are the experiences of attractions that constitute the major motivations for tourism (Quan & Wang, 2004), and whether food consumption in tourism can become a part of peak experiences depends substantially on its memorability in the overall tourist experience. Memories influence destination choices, because people often nostalgically revisit places associated with positive memories of an earlier journey (Marschall, 2014). Although several researchers have elucidated the importance of memorable experiences in tourist activities, few relevant empirical studies have been conducted (Hung, Lee, & Huang, 2014; Ali, Ryu, & Hussain, 2015). Therefore, this study aimed to determine how to create a memorable tourism experience at reused buildings at heritage sites; verified the relationships amongst motivation, nostalgia, and memorable tourism experiences; and modelled the variables at a train station reused as a restaurant heritage site.

Literature review and hypotheses

Reuse heritage

The reuse of buildings for new purposes is not new. Throughout history, people have constantly changed the uses of buildings as the buildings age and become inappropriate for the uses for which they were built (Amayu, 2014). The conversions of the Athena Temple in Syracuse into a church by about 800 and Roman theatres into apartments in the Middle Ages are testaments of how ancient the practice of building reuse is (de Vries, 1990 cited in Velthuis & Spennemann, 2007). Adaptive reuse can be defined as any work or intervention for changing the capacity, function, or performance of a building to suit new conditions or requirements (Yung & Chan, 2012).

Reusing heritage sites involves a gentrification process that is an integral part of heritage preservation and promotion at many tourist destinations. Repurposing vacant or run-down heritage sites has a positive impact on the local community. Tourists may have excellence experiences at repurposed historic properties (Lee & Chhabra, 2015). Protecting old buildings by providing them with new functions whilst retaining their original characteristics facilitates saving historic buildings and benefits local economies (Dinçer & Ertugral, 2003). Several facilities were associated with the colonial tea industry in Ceylon, including clubs for planters and the houses and bungalows of managers and

staff on tea estates. Currently, some buildings remaining from the tea industry have been repurposed as heritage lodgings for tourists. Repurposing buildings associated with the colonial tea heritage through historic lodging helps tourists understand the involved history and experience a feeling of nostalgia (Aslam & Jolliffe, 2015).

Many unused church buildings that were structurally secure have also been adapted to changed needs or new functions. The adaptive reuse of old church buildings generally involves repurposing such historic buildings for economically viable new uses whilst preserving their heritage elements. Thus, adaptive reuse of old church buildings offers a creative and sustainable solution for economically revitalising neighbourhoods through urban regeneration, for preserving the heritage of the buildings, and for creating nostalgia and experiences for tourists after the buildings stop functioning as places of worship (Amayu, 2014).

Tourist motivation

Since the beginning of tourism research, scholars have attempted to identify motivations for travel. Since Dann (1977) introduced 'anomie' and 'ego-enhancement' motivations and Iso-Ahola (1982) introduced escape-seeking motivations, motivation research has continued to increase. In particular, Crompton's (1979) 'push' and 'pull' factors provide a simple and intuitive approach for examining tourism motivation and have been frequently applied. Push factors are viewed as the internal needs and desires of a person, whereas pull factors are related to the attractions and features of specific destination sites.

Previous studies have found that knowledge accumulation and education are the main motivations for heritage sites (Gonzalo, 2011; Kerstetter, Confer, & Graefe, 2001; Poria, Reichel, & Biran, 2006). Knowledge learning, authentic experiences, historical characteristics, and interest in history are the main motivations for visitors (Kerstetter et al., 2001). In addition, personal emotion is one of most crucial motivations for visiting heritage sites (Poria et al., 2003). Poria, Butler, and Airey (2004) indicated that emotion, which in this context is a sense of responsibility for and inheritance of heritage, and a strong desire for connection with the context in which tourists live are motivations for tourists to visit heritage sites. Motivations for tourists to visit the Anne Frank House in Amsterdam are to learn the involved history, enhance their knowledge of the attraction, and assume the responsibility of inheriting the culture (Poria et al., 2006). Heritage tourism is a product that comprises education and learning as the basic components. Heritage sites exhibit potential for attracting tourists because learning is a main travel motivation of tourists (Gonzalo, 2011). Educational motivations, emotional involvement, the desire to maintain one's identity by connecting with one's heritage and understanding oneself, and the desire for authentic experiences are crucial motivations for heritage tourism (Biran, Poria, & Oren, 2011). The pursuit of an aesthetic sense and historical, cultural, and educational value is the motivation for visiting intangible cultural heritage attractions (Sun & Shi, 2012).

Nostalgia

The term 'nostalgia' was first used by Hofer (1688) to describe Swiss soldiers who were extremely homesick and longing for home. Nostalgia is no longer used to describe homesickness, but currently refers to people attempting to discover their past. Nostalgia is a wistful mood that may be prompted by an object, scene, smell, or strain of music (Belk, 1990). Nostalgia also refers to a longing for the past, a yearning for yesterday, or a fondness for possessions and activities associated with past times (Holbrook, 1993). Fairley (2003) defined nostalgia as a preference (general liking, positive attitude, or favourable affect) towards objects (people, places, or experiences) from a person's youth or times when a person learned vicariously, perhaps through socialisation or the media.

The concept of nostalgia has been used in the consumer behaviour and psychology fields. Batcho (1995) indicated that nostalgia is a psychological perspective comprising several factors reflecting various spheres and levels of experience. Schindler and Holbrook (2003) indicated nostalgia was conceptualised as a multifaceted, composite construct, and results were discussed according to four perspectives: generational, developmental, personality, and transient mood state. Men, but not

women, showed evidence of nostalgic attachment to the styles prevalent in their youth; in other words, men showed preferences for products that were popular when they were young.

Nostalgic memories can be pleasant, albeit bittersweet, and benefit well-being (Cavanagh, Glode, & Opitz, 2015; Routledge, Wildschut, Sedikides, & Juhl, 2013; Verplanken, 2012; Zhou, Wildschut, Sedikides, Chen, & Vingerhoets, 2012). They are a crucial source of psychological health and well-being. In addition, nostalgia enhances psychological health and well-being and promotes adaptive psychological functioning amongst people at risk of poor mental health (Routledge et al., 2013). Nostalgia involves a fond recollection of people and events from the past. It may ameliorate negative affective states such as loneliness and boredom. Furthermore, nostalgic event memories lead to blunted recovery from a sad mood, compared with ordinary event memories, and are associated with the degree of confidence that a person has in his or her social relationships (Cavanagh et al., 2015).

Relationship between motivation and nostalgia

Some researchers have indicated a positive relationship between personal emotion and nostalgia (Cheng, Chen, & Chang, 2004; Gordon, 2013; Lo, 2006). In one study, tourists preferred a heritage tour in a simple and warm atmosphere that induces peacefulness, mixed emotions, and nostalgia for the heritage site (Cheng et al., 2004). When visitors experience a stronger positive emotion regarding a reused building at a heritage site, they have a stronger nostalgic experience (Lo, 2006). Nostalgia, a sentimental longing or wistful affection for the past, is derived from a predominantly personal and social emotion. Nostalgia also maintains psychological comfort (Zhou et al., 2012). Gordon (2013) found that nostalgic sport tourism attractions enable tourists to combine personal emotions with perceived nostalgic experiences induced by symbols at the heritage site.

Researchers have observed a relationship between knowledge learning and nostalgia (Fairley & Gammon, 2005; Wang, Shen, & Cheng, 2014; Willson & McIntosh, 2007; Wu & Lee, 2013). Learning about past events was reported to be a potent generator of nostalgia, particularly at nostalgic sport tourism attractions (Fairley & Gammon, 2005). In particular, tourists are increasingly concerned not only with being in the heritage buildings at Hawke's Bay but also with learning about the heritage sites; this enables tourists to experience nostalgia through knowledge learning (Willson & McIntosh, 2007). Wu and Lee (2013) examined the push and pull factors of tourist motivation and observed that knowledge learning is the most crucial motivation of travellers on an old mountain railway. Individuals must engage in knowledge learning independently to experience or enhance their feelings of nostalgia (Wang et al., 2014).

Regarding the relationship between culinary attraction and nostalgia, Timothy and Ron (2013) determined that cuisine and delicacies are crucial elements of the broader system of cultural heritage; the attraction of delicacies in cultural heritage tourism is a crucial factor associated with nostalgia. *Culinary Nostalgia*, the first Western-language book to explore the unique meaning that Chinese people attach to their country's many distinct regional foods, as well as the shifting roles that Western food plays in urban life, describes a positive relationship between culinary attraction and nostalgia (Swislocki, 2009). In addition, the culinary movement in the Mexican border town of Tijuana integrates conventional nostalgia. Tourists are motivated by local and regional cuisines with seasonal delicacies, which evoke a sense of nostalgia (Walker, 2013). Sharma (2014) reported that original recipes used to prepare delicacies for visitors enabled them to feel nostalgic and reminisce at Awadh's bazaar in Lucknow. Leong, Yeh, Hsiao, and Huan (2015) confirmed the relationship between motivation and nostalgia. Tourists who were attracted by Macau's cuisine and heritage attributes experienced a high level of nostalgia.

Regarding the relationship between cultural inheritance and nostalgia, tourists visiting an old railway station could easily experience the ancient cultural atmosphere and develop a sense of cultural inheritance, which could enhance a feeling of nostalgia (Lai & Chen, 2010). The Yami people on the island of Lan-Yu use various plants and animals, which are associated with spiritual symbolism, to protect their aboriginal culture, manifest their conceptions of an ancestral power, and elicit a feeling of nostalgia (Hu, 2008). Enhancing Kaohsiung, Taiwan residents' awareness and attitudes towards cultural inheritance influences their nostalgia and feelings for the Gang-Shan Bamboo Basket Festival (Lin, 2011). The concept of cultural inheritance is highly relevant to local cuisine. A favourable attitude

towards cultural inheritance regarding local food can influence the overall satisfaction and sense of nostalgia of tourists, evoking topophilia for an attraction (Chen & Sun, 2008). Accordingly, the following hypotheses were formulated.

Hypothesis 1. Personal emotion has a significantly positive relationship with nostalgia at a railway station reused as a restaurant heritage site.

Hypothesis 2. Knowledge learning has a significantly positive relationship with nostalgia at a railway station reused as a restaurant heritage site.

Hypothesis 3. Culinary attraction has a significantly positive relationship with nostalgia at a railway station reused as a restaurant heritage site.

Hypothesis 4. Cultural inheritance has a significantly positive relationship with nostalgia at a railway station reused as a restaurant heritage site.

Memorable tourism experiences

The concept of memorable tourism experiences is relatively new and was first proposed by Kim, Ritchie, and Tung in 2010. A person can forget the exact location and date of a visit, but rarely forgets the feeling and emotion experienced whilst performing a particular activity (Kim, Ritchie, & Tung, 2010). Kim, Ritchie, and McCormick (2012) proposed that a memorable tourism experience has been operationally defined as a tourism experience positively remembered and recalled after the event has occurred. The dimensions of a memorable tourism experience has been examined as hedonism, involvement, local culture, refreshment, meaningfulness, knowledge and novelty.

The cross-cultural validity of the Memorable Tourism Experience Scale, a recently developed measurement scale designed to assess respondents' memorable tourism experiences, was established (Kim & Ritchie, 2014); therefore, the memorable tourism experience concept has been applied in tourism studies (Ali, Hussain, & Ragavan, 2014; Ali et al., 2015; Horváth, 2012; Kruger & Saayman, 2012; Mathisen, 2012) and examined in conjunction with other variables. For example, four critical success factors were identified as necessary for a memorable spectator experience at the Two Oceans Marathon in Cape Town, South Africa: amenities, comfort and visibility, marketing, and personnel and provisions (Kruger & Saayman, 2012). A positive intercorrelation amongst education, entertainment, escapism, and memories at Malaysian resort hotels was confirmed (Ali et al., 2014).

Relationship between motivation and memorable tourism experiences

Personal emotion is a predictor of memorable experiences (Gordon, 2013; Jones, 2007; Kerr, 2013). Emotions are systemic and interact constantly with people's conscious and unconscious selves, particularly whilst they visit a place; emotions connect and produce memories of the environment (Jones, 2007). Visitors experienced strong emotional responses and memories of the landscape when travelling to nineteenth-century shipwrecks in Anzac Cove, Gallipoli Peninsula, Turkey (Kerr, 2013). Emotions produced during sport tourism experiences are a crucial component of individual and collective memory (Gordon, 2013). The positive emotional state of activation contributes to creating memories (Loureiro, 2014).

Regarding the relationship between knowledge learning and memorable experiences, knowledge learning from a tourist experience is likely influenced by tourists' expectations and memories (Falk, Ballantyne, Packer, & Benckendorff, 2012). The educational aspects of wildlife tourism experiences not only affect visitors' knowledge learning and subsequent behaviour but also are a crucial contributor to long-lasting memories and satisfaction (Ballantyne, Packer, & Sutherland, 2011). Tourists can learn the history when visiting the Nei Men Song Jiang Zhen Festival in Kaohsiung, Taiwan, thereby

acquiring unforgettable memories and the intention to revisit the festival in the future (YangTseng, 2012). Learning about local culture, including residents' way of life, and the language of the destination significantly enhanced memorable tourism experiences (Tung & Ritchie, 2011).

Certain researchers have indicated that culinary attraction and memorable experiences are positively related. Tourists had strong experiences at a local seafood restaurant; these experiences enhanced their experiential memory towards a fishery village in Chiayi, Taiwan (Shen, Lin, Ye, & Lin, 2011). Han (2012) examined the transformation of the food and cultural industries in Jiufen, Taiwan, observing that visitors enjoy the local cuisine and teahouse culture and thus have a positive memorable experience. Delicacies and memories are inseparable in tourism; during their trip, tourists experience satisfying food and beverages that evoke memories after their trip (Chen, Chang, & Lin, 2013). Furthermore, eating typical traditional dishes strengthens visitors' family roots, which are maintained from generation to generation, and every time these dishes are eaten, they trigger feelings and gustatory memory, according to a study in Brazil (Bortnowska & Alberton, 2015).

Some researchers have indicated a positive relationship between cultural inheritance and memorable experiences (Bessière, 2013; Luo & Yuan, 2011; Ma, 2009). The South Korean government attaches substantial importance to protecting UNESCO sites and promotes local culture to tourists. One study reported that local residents developed cognition of cultural inheritance, perceived cultural value, and memorability regarding heritage (Ma, 2009). Most French residents desire to perpetuate the inheritance of food heritage, enabling them to enhance their local memories, and consider this perpetuation crucial for rural development strategies (Bessière, 2013). Luo and Yuan (2011) proposed an outline of the relationship between ecotype urban heritage tourism and conservation and inheritance. Residents' attitudes towards inheritance enable enhancing memory and urban identity. Accordingly, the following hypotheses were formulated.

Hypothesis 5. Personal emotion has a significantly positive relationship with memorable tourism experiences at a railway station reused as a restaurant heritage site.

Hypothesis 6. Knowledge learning has a significantly positive relationship with memorable tourism experiences at a railway station reused as a restaurant heritage site.

Hypothesis 7. Culinary attraction has a significantly positive relationship with memorable tourism experiences at a railway station reused as a restaurant heritage site.

Hypothesis 8. Cultural inheritance has a significantly positive relationship with memorable tourism experiences at a railway station reused as a restaurant heritage site.

Relationship between nostalgia and memorable tourism experiences

Regarding the relationship between nostalgia and memory, some studies have indicated that tourists easily experience nostalgia, which evokes memorability of reconstructed heritage sites (Bartoletti, 2010; Gordon, 2013; Soscia, 2013; Tu, 2012). Commodification and late modernity prompt tourists to experience nostalgia, and a positive correlation exists between nostalgia and memorability (Bartoletti, 2010). The reuse and planning strategies for many attractions and dining spaces in old buildings enable visitors to perceive a nostalgic atmosphere and thus have a positive memorable experience (Tu, 2012). According to the postmodernist perspective, Gordon (2013) determined that nostalgia and memories are intercorrelated and tourists visiting nostalgic sport tourism locations recall personal memories. Nostalgia evokes a bittersweet sensation characterised by happy moments and pleasant memories accompanied by an awareness that those moments are associated with an irretrievable past (Soscia, 2013). Homesick tourists are characterised by a unique 'tourist gaze'. Homesick tourism shares with migrant return travel the importance of identity, emotions, nostalgia, and memorable experiences (Marschall, 2014).

Hypothesis 9. Nostalgia has a significantly positive relationship with memorable tourism experiences at a railway station reused as a restaurant heritage site.

The effect of nostalgia on motivation and memorable tourism experiences is unclear. The current study focused on the effect of nostalgia on tourist motivation regarding a reconstructed heritage site and proposed the following hypotheses:

Hypothesis 10. Nostalgia mediates the relationship between personal emotion and memorable tourism experiences at a railway station reused as a restaurant heritage site.

Hypothesis 11. Nostalgia mediates the relationship between knowledge learning and memorable tourism experiences at a railway station reused as a restaurant heritage site.

Hypothesis 12. Nostalgia mediates the relationship between culinary attraction and memorable tourism experiences at a railway station reused as a restaurant heritage site.

Hypothesis 13. Nostalgia mediates the relationship between cultural inheritance and memorable tourism experiences at a railway station reused as a restaurant heritage site.

Methodology

A questionnaire survey was adopted for this study; the target participants were visitors in the old South Tainan Railway Station. The questionnaire was designed with reference to concepts developed from the reviewed literature. The questionnaire was then pretested on a sample of 100 visitors in old South Tainan Railway Station. Changes were made according to the results of the pilot study.

Instrumentation

Demographics and travel characteristics

The usual demographic variables, such as age, gender, and marital status, were included in the survey so that general explanatory variables could be identified and to allow comparisons with other studies. The variables of travel characteristics were selected with reference to other relevant studies (Chen & Chen, 2010; Poria et al., 2004).

Motivation

The measurement of motivation was developed in accordance with the work of Poria et al. (2004), Shen, Tseng, and Hsiao (2009) and Biran et al. (2011). Twenty one items such as 'This old station makes me feel relaxed', 'I feel a sense of belonging to the site' and 'I want to learn the history of this station', were listed and visitors were asked to indicate their levels of agreement, from *strongly disagree* (1) to *strongly agree* (5).

Nostalgia

The participants also completed a self-reported 8-item questionnaire developed by Stern (1992), Holbrook (1993) and Dai, Lin, and Chen (2010). Eight items, including statements such as 'I can recall my past life through this station', 'I can perceive the transition of this station', and 'This station makes me think of unforgettable friends', were listed, and the visitors were asked to indicate their levels of agreement, from *strongly disagree* (1) to *strongly agree* (5).

Memorable tourism experiences

Memorable Tourism Experiences was measured according to Kim et al. (2012). Twenty-four items, including statements such as 'Closely experienced the local culture', 'Different from previous

experiences' and 'Once-in-a-lifetime experience', were listed and visitors were asked to indicate their levels of agreement, from *strongly disagree* (1) to *strongly agree* (5).

The sample

We chose Tainan as the investigation location because it contains some of the primary heritage sites in Taiwan. The South Tainan Railway Station was built in 1943 and has been used as a restaurant since 2010. The station was originally built for air force transportation, and its operation was discontinued because of typhoon damage. The railway station was a place for people to meet and bid farewell to friends and relatives. Accordingly, the South Tainan Railway Station was chosen for the survey to explore the relationships amongst motivation, nostalgia, and memorable tourism experiences.

The study respondents were notified that the information that they provided would be strictly confidential and anonymous and used only for academic purposes. [Veal's \(2011\)](#) observational method was used to determine the footfall at different times of the day. An on-site survey was conducted using a self-administered questionnaire at the South Tainan Railway Station. Visitors who finished their meal in the restaurant were invited to complete the questionnaire. The survey was conducted on numerous weekdays and weekends and at various times of the day to acquire a comprehensive sample of visitors.

Data analysis

Data analysis was conducted using the Statistical Package for the Social Sciences version 20.0. Descriptive statistical analysis, reliability analysis, factor analysis, and correlation analysis were performed. The scales of motivation, nostalgia, and memorable tourism experiences were adopted from previous studies conducted in different countries. To verify the applicability of the items to the reused heritage site and cultural context of Taiwan, the scale development technique developed by [DeVellis \(2012\)](#) was employed. AMOS 20.0 was used for conducting a two-stage structural equation modelling procedure suggested by [Anderson and Gerbing \(1988\)](#). First, confirmatory factor analysis was conducted to examine the psychometric properties of the measures. Subsequently, a general SEM technique was used to test the validity of the proposed model and the hypotheses.

The main survey was conducted in July 2013 to October 2013. A total of 630 questionnaires were distributed, and 615 valid responses were returned. To determine the underlying factor structures, 300 responses were chosen randomly, and the remaining 315 responses were used for examining the reliability and validity of the measurement model as well as the hypotheses regarding the relationships amongst motivation, nostalgia, and memorable tourism experiences.

Results

The respondents

The majority of the respondents were single (75%), and 55 per cent of them were male. Approximately half of the respondents were aged between 21 and 30, and most of them were college or university educated (64%). The results revealed that most of the tourists visited South Tainan Railway Station by motorcycle (48%) or by car (33%), and 46 per cent of respondents obtained information about South Tainan Railway Station from their relatives and friends. Most of the respondents (46%) stayed in this heritage for one to two hours (see [Table 1](#)).

Motivation of visitors

In terms of the motivation of visitors, most of the attitudes assessed on the five-point scale items had a mean score above 3. The top two items 'I want to walk around in here' (mean = 3.85) and 'Visit this old railway station can learn new things' (mean = 3.69) indicated that the respondents were likely

Table 1Demographic and travel characteristic of respondents (*N* = 315).

Characteristic	Frequency	%	Characteristic	Frequency	%
Gender			Education level		
Male	175	55.6	Elementary school	10	3.2
Female	140	44.4	Junior high school	15	1.8
Marital status			Senior high school	70	22.2
Single	238	75.6	College/University	202	64.1
Married	70	22.2	Postgraduate	18	5.7
Other	7	2.2	Age group		
Length of stay			Under 20	56	17.8
Within 1 h	120	38.1	21–30	179	56.8
1–2 h	146	46.3	31–40	58	18.4
2–3 h	47	14.9	41–50	17	5.4
Over 3 h	2	.6	51–60	5	1.6
Information about the heritage			Transportation used		
Relatives & friends	147	46.7	Motorcycle	153	48.6
Internet	111	35.2	Car	104	33.0
Television	25	7.9	Bicycle	20	6.3
Newspaper	17	5.4	Walking	15	4.8
Magazine	11	3.5	Bus	11	3.5
Travel agencies	2	.6	Taxi	6	1.9
Others	2	.6	Others	6	1.9

to learn the culture from the heritage. A factor analysis was carried out to reveal dimensions that can be indicative of responses. The analysis showed four factors explaining 70.1 per cent of the variance.

Factor 1 consisted of 6 items that were related to self-identity and memories, and it was thus named 'personal emotion'. Factor 2 included 5 items such as 'I want to learn the history of this old railway station' and 'I want to improve the knowledge of this old railway station'. As discussed above, relating to 'knowledge learning', Factor 3 was made up six 'culinary attraction' related items, such as 'To experience the cuisine and heritage', 'Visit this old station to try special food' and 'Visit this old station is one of my leisure activities'. Factor 4 consisted of 4 items that were related to place attachment, and it was thus named 'cultural inheritance'. The factor loadings for the 21 items ranged from 0.55 to 0.84, and the reliability alphas for four domains and the overall scale were all above 0.87, indicating that the criteria were met (Nunnally, 1978).

The CFA was applied to test the validity of the questionnaire. Six items were deleted due to the poor indices of overall fits. The final results of CFA indicated that the validity of personal emotion ($\chi^2 = 9.86$, *df* = 2, GFI = 0.96, CFI = 0.96, AGFI = 0.82, and RMSEA = 0.08), knowledge learning (just identified model), culinary attraction ($\chi^2 = 5.28$, *df* = 2, GFI = 0.99, CFI = 0.99, AGFI = 0.96, and RMSEA = 0.07), cultural inheritance ($\chi^2 = 9.71$, *df* = 2, GFI = 0.96, CFI = 0.96, AGFI = 0.80, and RMSEA = 0.08) were satisfactory.

Nostalgia of visitors

Regarding the nostalgia of visitors, most of the attitudes assessed on the 5-point scale had a mean score higher than 3 were complete. The top two items 'This old station makes me want to go back to good old days' (mean = 3.91) and 'This old station makes me think of unforgettable friends' (mean = 3.81) indicated that the respondents were most impressed by the sense of nostalgia in South Tainan Railway Station. A factor analysis was carried out to reveal dimensions that can be indicative of responses. The analysis showed four factors explaining 73.1 per cent of the variance.

Factor 1 consisted of 8 items that were related to the cognition of social transition and past life-style, and it was thus named 'historical nostalgia', such as 'I can perceive the change of this place' and 'I can image the events of the past time'. Factor 2 was made up four 'personal nostalgia' related items, such as 'This old station makes me think of unforgettable time' and 'This old station makes

me think of unforgettable friends'. The factor loadings for the 8 items ranged from 0.68 to 0.91. The reliability alphas for two domains and the overall scale were all above 0.80, indicating that the criteria were met (Nunnally, 1978).

The CFA was applied to test the validity of the questionnaire. The results of CFA indicated that the validity of nostalgia scale was good ($\chi^2 = 62.8$, $df = 19$, p -value = 0.00, GFI = 0.95, CFI = 0.97, AGFI = 0.90, and RMSEA = 0.08).

Memorable tourism experiences of visitors

Regarding the memorable tourism experiences of visitors, most of the attitudes assessed on the 5-point scale had a mean score higher than 3 were complete. The top two items 'I enjoyed activities which I really wanted to do' (mean = 3.89) and 'Enjoyed sense of freedom' (mean = 3.88) indicated that the respondents were most impressed by the memorable experiences in South Tainan Railway Station. A factor analysis was carried out to reveal dimensions that can be indicative of responses. The analysis showed six factors explaining 75.6 per cent of the variance.

Factor 1 consisted of 7 items that were related to enjoy this experience and feel exciting, and it was thus named 'hedonism'. Factor 2 was made up four 'local culture' related items, such as 'Good impressions about the local people' and 'Closely experienced the local culture'. Factor 3 included 4 items such as 'Liberating' and 'Enjoyed sense of freedom'. As discussed above, relating to 'refreshment'. Factor 4 was made up four 'meaningfulness' related items, such as 'I did something meaningful' and 'I did something important'. Factor 5 consisted of 3 items that were related to exploratory and new culture, and it was thus named 'knowledge'. Factor 6 consisted of 2 items that were related to visit and enjoy the place and activity, and it was thus named 'involvement', such as 'I visited a place where I really wanted to go'. The factor loadings for the 24 items ranged from 0.54 to 0.83. The reliability alphas for six domains and the overall scale were all above 0.81, indicating that the criteria were met (Nunnally, 1978).

The CFA was applied to test the validity of the questionnaire. Seven items and the 'involvement' dimension were deleted due to poor indices of overall fits. The results of CFA indicated that the validity of memorable tourism experiences scale was acceptable ($\chi^2 = 319.5$, $df = 109$, p -value = 0.00, GFI = 0.90, CFI = 0.94, AGFI = 0.86, and RMSEA = 0.07).

The relationships amongst motivation, nostalgia and memorable tourism experiences

As shown in Table 2, the four dimensions of motivation and nostalgia were significantly correlated, and the Pearson correlation coefficients ranged between .66 and .72 ($p < 0.01$). The relationship between nostalgia and memorable tourism was also found to be positive, with the correlation coefficient of .82 ($p < 0.01$). Furthermore, the relationship between motivation and memorable tourism experiences was also found to be positive, with the correlation coefficients ranged from .67 to .80 ($p < 0.01$).

Table 2
Inter-correlations between the variables.

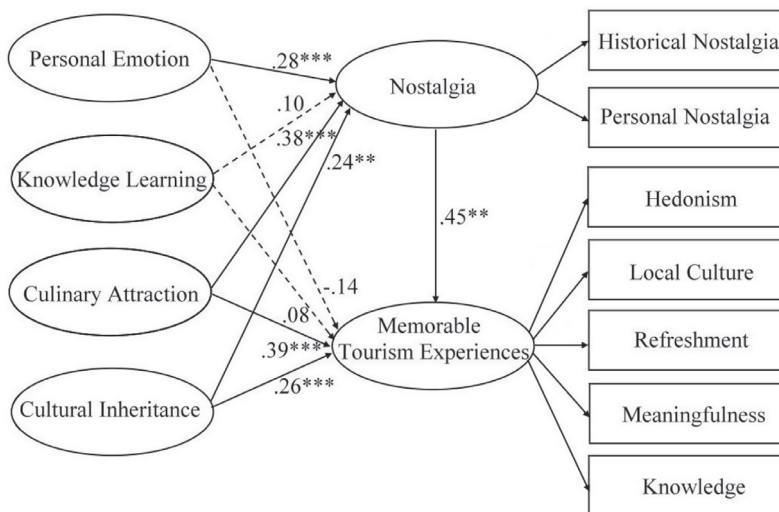
	Mean	SD	CR	AVE	1	2	3	4	5	6
1. Personal emotion	3.59	.77	.87	.64	1					
2. Knowledge learning	3.64	.80	.87	.69	.61**	1				
3. Culinary attraction	3.65	.78	.80	.51	.62**	.70**	1			
4. Cultural inheritance	3.61	.82	.88	.64	.61**	.64**	.61**	1		
5. Nostalgia	3.68	.74	.75	.61	.69**	.69**	.72**	.66**	1	
6. Memorable tourism experiences	3.72	.66	.87	.58	.67**	.76**	.80**	.72**	.82**	1

Note: ** $p < 0.01$; The Composite Reliability (CR) is a measure of the overall reliability of a collection of heterogeneous. The Average Variance Extracted (AVE) is used to evaluate convergent validity. AVE estimate is the average amount of variation that a latent construct is able to explain in the observed variables to which it is theoretically related.

The resulting data were then analysed by using AMOS software to conduct the structural equation modelling analysis. The multiple indices of model fit, including the chi-square statistic, the comparative fit index (CFI), Bollen's incremental fit index (IFI), Tucker-Lewis index (TLI), the goodness-of-fit index (GFI), and the adjusted goodness of fit index (AGFI), standardised root mean square residual (SRMR), root mean square error of approximation (RMSEA), were examined as recommended by a number of researchers (Baumgartner & Homburg, 1996; Bollen, 1989; Chin & Todd, 1995; Doll, Xia, & Torkzadeh, 1994; Jöreskog & Sörbom, 1993; Mueller, 1996). According to the analysis of results, all the indices of overall fits were satisfactory ($\chi^2 = 533.8$, $df = 194$, $\chi^2/df = 2.75$, p -value = 0.00, CFI = .92, IFI = .92, TLI = .91, GFI = .87, AGFI = .83, SRMR = .03, and RMSEA = .07).

Fig. 1 shows the standardised path coefficients with associated t -values for all relationships in the structural model. The results reveal parameters for the path between personal emotion and nostalgia ($\beta = .28$, $p < .001$), culinary attraction and nostalgia ($\beta = .38$, $p < .001$) and for that between cultural inheritance and nostalgia ($\beta = .24$, $p < .01$). The results revealed significantly positive relationships between personal emotion, culinary attraction, cultural inheritance and nostalgia. The results were consistent with the statement of Hypothesis 1, Hypothesis 3 and Hypothesis 4. However, the results reveal parameters for the path between knowledge learning and nostalgia ($\beta = .10$, $p = .23$). The result was inconsistent with the statement of Hypothesis 2.

Regarding to motivation and memorable experiences, the results reveal parameters for the path between personal emotion and memorable experiences ($\beta = -.14$, $p = .05$) and for that between knowledge learning and memorable experiences ($\beta = .08$, $p = .22$). The results were inconsistent with the statement of Hypothesis 5 and Hypothesis 6. Besides, the results reveal parameters for the path between culinary attraction and memorable experiences ($\beta = .39$, $p < .001$) and for that between cultural inheritance and memorable experiences ($\beta = .26$, $p < .001$). The results revealed significantly positive relationships between personal emotion and memorable experiences as well as between



Note: Chi-square = 553.8, $df = 194$, $\chi^2/df = 2.75$, CFI = .92, IFI = .92, TLI = .91, GFI = .87, AGFI = .83, SRMR = .03, RMSEA = .07, ** $p < .01$, *** $p < .001$; Solid lines represent significant relationships with standardised β coefficients; dashed lines represent non-significant relationships with standardised β coefficients and p values.

Fig. 1. Mediating effects of nostalgia on motivation and memorable tourism experiences, using structural equation modelling analysis.

Table 3

Standardised direct, indirect and total effects of relationships.

Path	Standardised direct effect	Standardised indirect effect	Standardised total effect	t-Value
Personal emotion → Nostalgia	.28	–	.28	3.67***
Knowledge learning → Nostalgia	.10	–	.10	1.18
Culinary attraction → Nostalgia	.38	–	.38	3.86***
Cultural inheritance → Nostalgia	.24	–	.24	2.94**
Personal emotion → Memorable tourism experiences	–.14	.13	–.01	–1.93
Knowledge learning → Memorable tourism experiences	.08	.05	.13	1.21
Culinary attraction → Memorable tourism experiences	.39	.17	.56	3.92***
Cultural inheritance → Memorable tourism experiences	.26	.10	.37	3.60***
Nostalgia → Memorable tourism experiences	.45	–	.45	3.18**

Note: ** $p < 0.01$, *** $p < 0.001$

cultural inheritance and memorable experiences. Therefore, the results were consistent with the statement of Hypothesis 7 and Hypothesis 8.

The results also reveal significant parameters for the path between nostalgia and memorable experiences ($\beta = .45$, $p < .01$). Hypothesis 9 was, therefore, supported. Finally, it was assumed that nostalgia would mediate the relationship between motivation and memorable experiences of the reused heritage. Nostalgia did play the role of a mediator between personal emotion and memorable experiences (see Table 3). The value of the standardised indirect effect (.13) between the relationship of personal emotion and memorable tourism experiences was higher than the standardised direct effect (–.14), thus supporting Hypothesis 10. In addition, the value of the standardised indirect effect (.05) between the relationship of knowledge learning and memorable tourism experiences was lower than the standardised direct effect (.08). The value of the standardised indirect effect (.17) between the relationship of culinary attraction and memorable tourism experiences was lower than the standardised direct effect (.39). The value of the standardised indirect effect (.11) between the relationship of cultural inheritance and memorable tourism experiences was lower than the standardised direct effect (.26). This means that nostalgia did not play the role of a mediator amongst knowledge learning, culinary attraction, cultural inheritance, and memorable tourism experiences, thus not supporting Hypothesis 11, Hypothesis 12 and Hypothesis 13.

Conclusion

This study examined the relationships amongst motivation, nostalgia, and memorable tourism experiences at the South Tainan Railway Station. To clarify the model fit and relationships amongst various motivations, nostalgia, and memorable tourism experiences at the reconstructed heritage site, we tested four motivations separately in the research model. The data clearly demonstrated a significant relationship between personal emotion and nostalgia amongst heritage tourism visitors. This finding is similar to that of Lo (2006), Cheng et al. (2004), and Gordon (2013). The data also indicated a positive correlation between culinary attraction and nostalgia at the South Tainan Railway Station. This finding is similar to those of relevant studies (Leong et al., 2015; Sharma, 2014; Timothy & Ron, 2013; Walker, 2013). In addition, the results confirm a positive relationship between cultural inheritance and nostalgia. This finding supports those of previous studies (Chen & Sun, 2008; Lai & Chen, 2010; Lin, 2011).

Several researchers have indicated that learning and inheritance are the main motivations in heritage tourism and produce a nostalgic reaction (Gonzalo, 2011; Kerstetter et al., 2001; Poria et al., 2006; Sun & Shi, 2012). Our results regarding learning are inconsistent with those of previous studies: No positive relationship was observed between knowledge learning and nostalgia. We determined that the past does not automatically induce a feeling of nostalgia. It is a necessary but insufficient

condition for nostalgia at reused buildings at heritage sites. Culinary attraction was found to be the most significant predictor of nostalgia, followed by personal emotion and cultural inheritance. Culinary narratives, infused with nostalgia, often evoke immigrant memories and imagined returns to the homeland (Katrak, 2006). Swislocki (2009) mentioned that culinary nostalgia, the recollection or purposive evocation of another time and place through food, is a time-honoured Chinese tradition. Our sample area combines the local features of Tainan and nostalgic cuisine in a well-planned environment. It elicits a feeling amongst visitors that they are returning to the past as well as a sense of nostalgia. Thus, the results of this study suggest that restaurants must attach importance to a well-designed menu and flavours to enhance customer attraction and elicit nostalgia. A well-planned maintenance programme and interpretation programme are also relevant for managers to increase personal emotion and cultural inheritance motivation and create a sense of nostalgia amongst visitors.

Regarding motivation and memorable experiences, the respondents who had high motivation towards a reconstructed heritage site were more likely to have highly memorable experiences. The respondent motivations of 'culinary attraction' and 'cultural inheritance' towards reconstructed heritage sites had a positive relationship with memorable experiences. These findings are consistent with those of previous studies (Bessière, 2013; Chen et al., 2013; Han, 2012; Luo & Yuan, 2011; Ma, 2009; Shen et al., 2011). The motivation of knowledge learning did not enhance the memorable tourism experience in our study. The attraction of cuisine was found to be the most significant predictor of a memorable experience for visitors, followed by cultural inheritance. Numerous dining spaces have been reconstructed from old buildings and heritage sites worldwide. Except for architectural decoration, cuisine remains the most crucial factor for operating a restaurant and eliciting memories at a reused building at a heritage site. Previous studies have indicated that if suppliers provide customers with unforgettable experiences, the revisit rate is likely to increase (Tung & Ritchie, 2011; Hung et al., 2014). Managers of restaurant heritage sites must attach importance to the food that they serve and integrate the flavour of local food to provide unforgettable memories in reused old buildings. This would facilitate establishing the core capability of the restaurant. The South Tainan Railway Station attracts numerous visitors by holding activities related to history. Organising celebrations to attract visitors is crucial to heritage site operation and management. Visitors who have a sense of cultural inheritance generate positive memories. Creating memories for visitors cannot depend on knowledge learning. Reused buildings at heritage sites must be designed to elicit favourable interpretations of historic events and preserve the authenticity of the buildings. Telling stories regarding heritage sites facilitates enhancing visitors' memorable experiences.

The study results also reveal positive correlations between nostalgia dimensions and memorable tourism experiences. This correlation result corresponds with those obtained by Havlena and Holak (1991), Bartoletti (2010), Tu (2012), Gordon (2013), and Soscia (2013). Havlena and Holak (1991) proposed that marketers encourage consumers to experience nostalgic feelings by using nostalgic themes in advertising to capture or create fantasy or memorable experiences. Tu (2012) indicated that because Tainan has many restaurants and tourist attractions in reused buildings at heritage sites, visitors can experience nostalgia when visiting these sites and thus have memorable experiences. Gordon (2013) reported a positive relationship between nostalgia and memories when tourists travelled to nostalgic sport tourism attractions. Nostalgia, a sentimental longing or wistful affection for the past, is a predominantly positive and social emotion. Nostalgia maintains psychological comfort; in one study, higher levels of music-evoked nostalgia predicted increased physical warmth, and participants who recalled a nostalgic event perceived the ambient temperature to be higher (Zhou et al., 2012). Decorating upholstery appropriately to attract tourists' attention, broadcasting nostalgic music to encourage them to listen, and providing traditional cuisine to stimulate their taste and smell can create memorable experiences for tourists at reused buildings at heritage sites. Combining these strategies for managing a restaurant heritage site facilitates enhancing visitors' nostalgia and creating memorable experiences.

This study confirmed the importance of nostalgia in heritage tourism research, verified the mediating effects of nostalgia on personal emotion and memorable tourism experiences, and determined no direct relationship between personal emotion and memorable tourism experiences. The findings from the observation of and informal interviews with the respondents may explain these results. Many visitors visited the reconstructed railway station only for dining. Some respondents further

indicated that the station provided a place for them to express personal feelings and caused them to recollect memories of the unique railway station that connected them to their past or memories of taking the railway at other railway stations. Personal emotion cannot directly influence memorable experiences at reconstructed heritage sites. However, managers of such sites can provide authentic furnishings and decor to enhance tourist nostalgia and employ the mediating effect of nostalgia on personal emotion and memorable experiences. These strategies can enhance memorable experiences amongst tourists and may increase the revisit intention, thus facilitating achievement of heritage sustainability.

The concept of memorable tourism experiences is relatively new. This study measured only the tourist perceptions of memorable experiences shortly after dining. Whether the perceived memorable experiences will last remains unclear; thus, more research is required. Although various types of reconstructed heritage site exist, the survey of the present study was limited to a reconstructed restaurant at the South Tainan Railway Station. We therefore suggest that future research examine the role of memorable tourism experiences in related tourist studies to construct an experience and behaviour model.

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